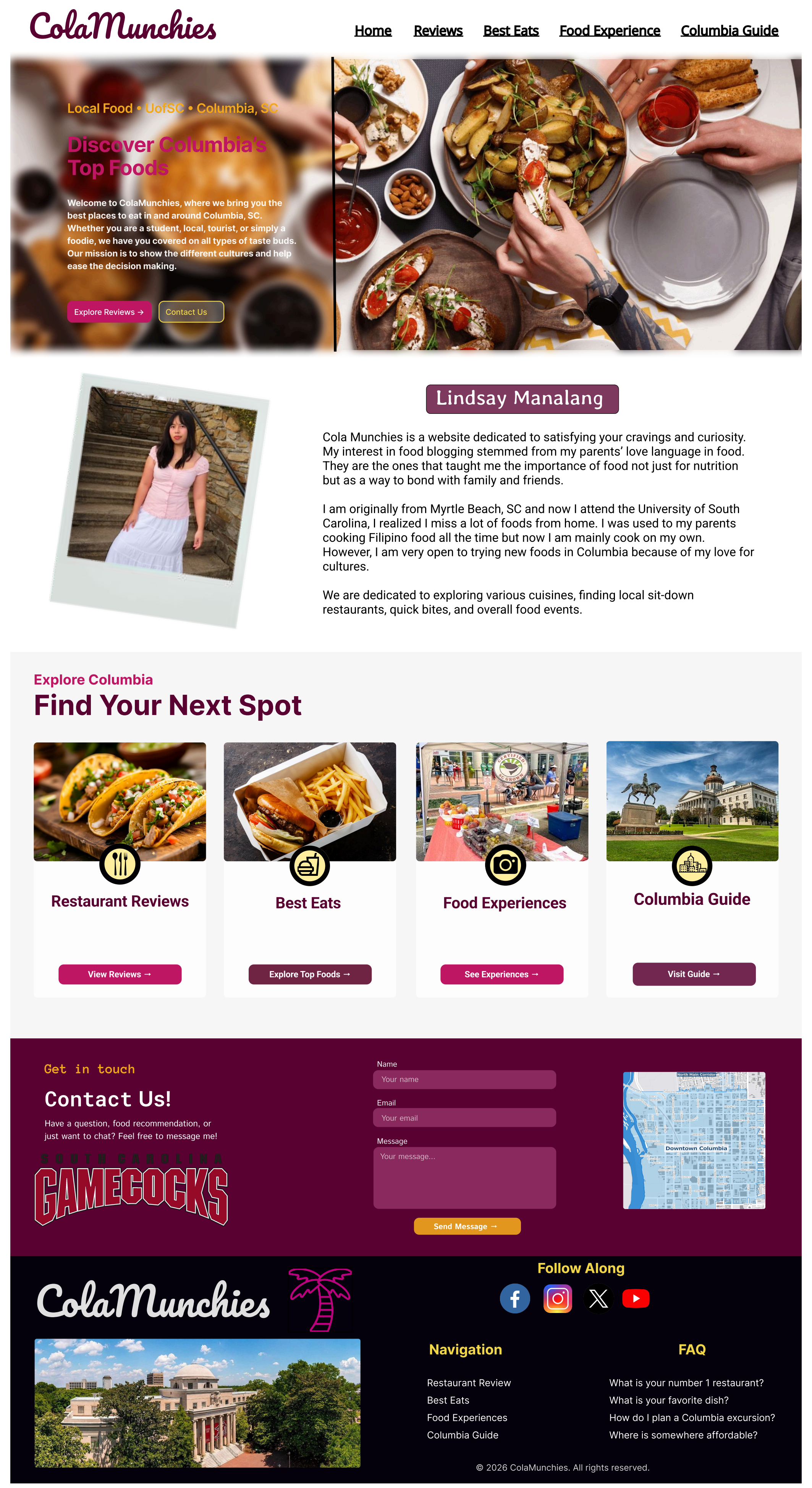

ColaMunchies

Home Reviews Best Eats Food Experience Columbia Guide

Local Food • UofSC • Columbia, SC

Discover Columbia's Top Foods

Welcome to ColaMunchies, where we bring you the best places to eat in and around Columbia, SC. Whether you are a student, local, tourist, or simply a foodie, we have you covered on all types of taste buds. Our mission is to show the different cultures and help ease the decision making.

Explore Reviews → Contact Us

Lindsay Manalang

Cola Munchies is a website dedicated to satisfying your cravings and curiosity. My interest in food blogging stemmed from my parents' love language in food. They are the ones that taught me the importance of food not just for nutrition but as a way to bond with family and friends.

I am originally from Myrtle Beach, SC and now I attend the University of South Carolina, I realized I miss a lot of foods from home. I was used to my parents cooking Filipino food all the time but now I am mainly cook on my own. However, I am very open to trying new foods in Columbia because of my love for cultures.

We are dedicated to exploring various cuisines, finding local sit-down restaurants, quick bites, and overall food events.

Explore Columbia

Find Your Next Spot

Restaurant Reviews View Reviews →

Best Eats Explore Top Foods →

Food Experiences See Experiences →

Columbia Guide Visit Guide →

Get in touch

Contact Us!

Have a question, food recommendation, or just want to chat? Feel free to message me!

Name: Your name
Email: Your email
Message: Your message...

Send Message →

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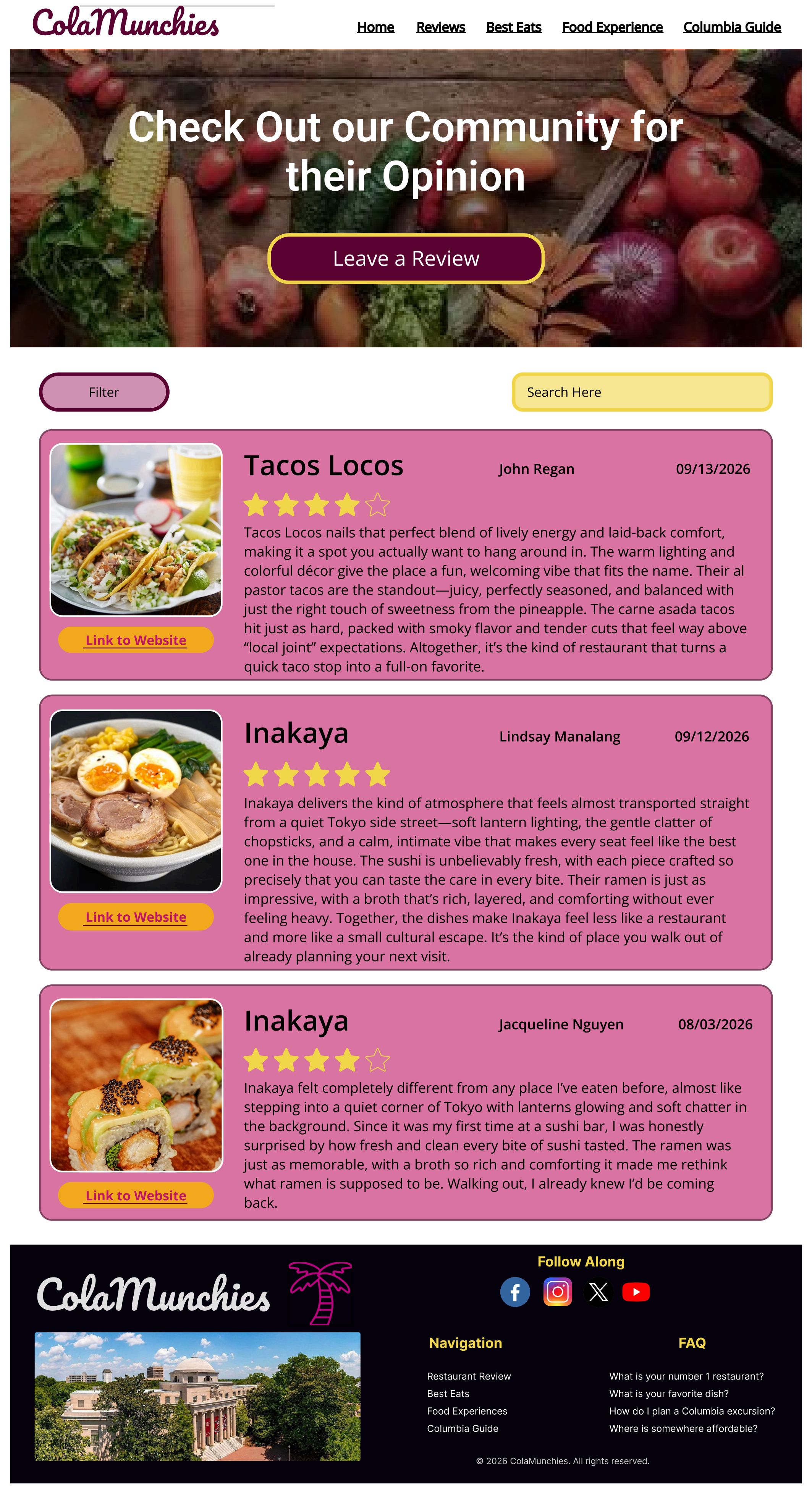

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Check Out our Community for their Opinion

Leave a Review

Filter   Search Here

Tacos Locos John Regan 09/13/2026

★★★★☆

Tacos Locos nails that perfect blend of lively energy and laid-back comfort, making it a spot you actually want to hang around in. The warm lighting and colorful décor give the place a fun, welcoming vibe that fits the name. Their al pastor tacos are the standout—juicy, perfectly seasoned, and balanced with just the right touch of sweetness from the pineapple. The carne asada tacos hit just as hard, packed with smoky flavor and tender cuts that feel way above "local joint" expectations. Altogether, it's the kind of restaurant that turns a quick taco stop into a full-on favorite.

Link to Website

Inakaya Lindsay Manalang 09/12/2026

★★★★★

Inakaya delivers the kind of atmosphere that feels almost transported straight from a quiet Tokyo side street—soft lantern lighting, the gentle clatter of chopsticks, and a calm, intimate vibe that makes every seat feel like the best one in the house. The sushi is unbelievably fresh, with each piece crafted so precisely that you can taste the care in every bite. Their ramen is just as impressive, with a broth that's rich, layered, and comforting without ever feeling heavy. Together, the dishes make Inakaya feel less like a restaurant and more like a small cultural escape. It's the kind of place you walk out of already planning your next visit.

Link to Website

Inakaya Jacqueline Nguyen 08/03/2026

★★★★☆

Inakaya felt completely different from any place I've eaten before, almost like stepping into a quiet corner of Tokyo with lanterns glowing and soft chatter in the background. Since it was my first time at a sushi bar, I was honestly surprised by how fresh and clean every bite of sushi tasted. The ramen was just as memorable, with a broth so rich and comforting it made me rethink what ramen is supposed to be. Walking out, I already knew I'd be coming back.

Link to Website

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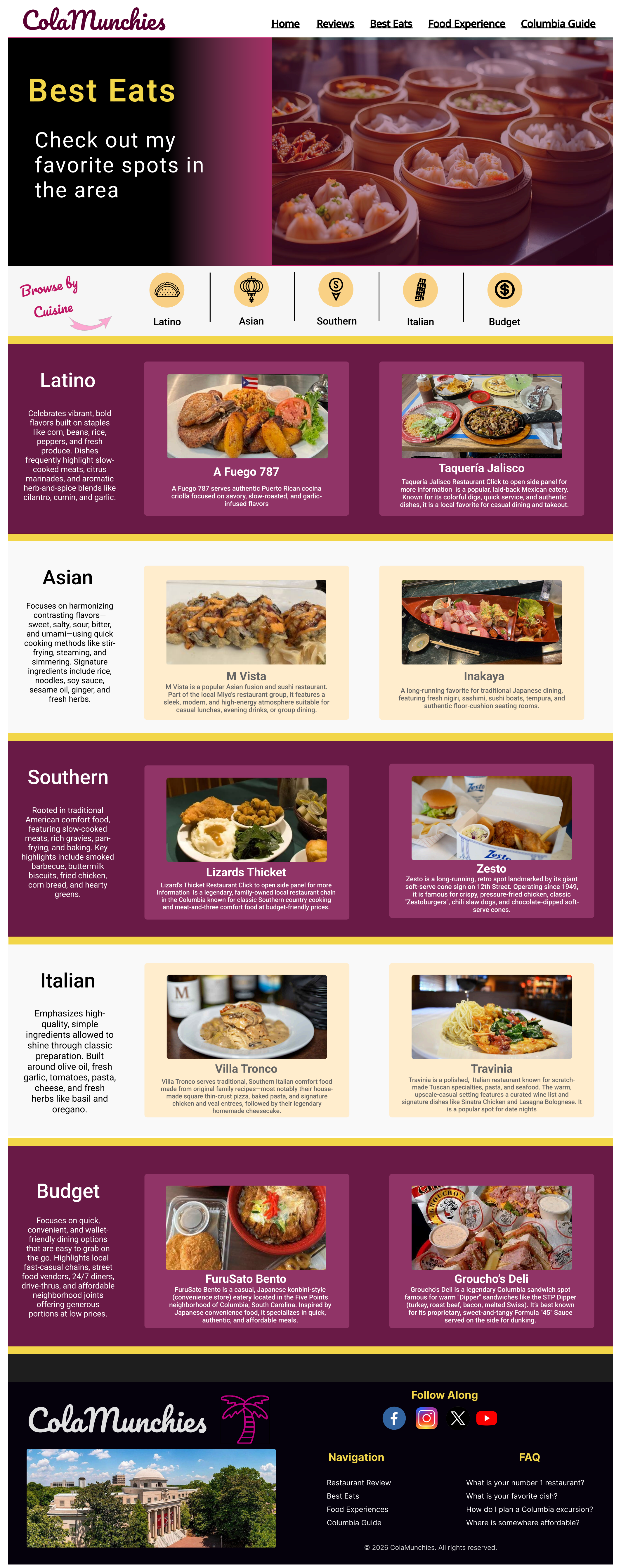

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Best Eats

Check out my favorite spots in the area

Browse by Cuisine

Latino | Asian | Southern | Italian | Budget

Latino

Celebrates vibrant, bold flavors built on staples like corn, beans, rice, peppers, and fresh produce. Dishes frequently highlight slow-cooked meats, citrus marinades, and aromatic herb-and-spice blends like cilantro, cumin, and garlic.

A Fuego 787

A Fuego 787 serves authentic Puerto Rican cocina criolla focused on savory, slow-roasted, and garlic-infused flavors

Taquería Jalisco

Taquería Jalisco Restaurant Click to open side panel for more information is a popular, laid-back Mexican eatery. Known for its colorful digs, quick service, and authentic dishes, it is a local favorite for casual dining and takeout.

Asian

Focuses on harmonizing contrasting flavors—sweet, salty, sour, bitter, and umami—using quick cooking methods like stir-frying, steaming, and simmering. Signature ingredients include rice, noodles, soy sauce, sesame oil, ginger, and fresh herbs.

M Vista

M Vista is a popular Asian fusion and sushi restaurant. Part of the local Miyo's restaurant group, it features a sleek, modern, and high-energy atmosphere suitable for casual lunches, evening drinks, or group dining.

Inakaya

A long-running favorite for traditional Japanese dining, featuring fresh nigiri, sashimi, sushi boats, tempura, and authentic floor-cushion seating rooms.

Southern

Rooted in traditional American comfort food, featuring slow-cooked meats, rich gravies, pan-frying, and baking. Key highlights include smoked barbecue, buttermilk biscuits, fried chicken, corn bread, and hearty greens.

Lizards Thicket

Lizard's Thicket Restaurant Click to open side panel for more information is a legendary, family-owned local restaurant chain in the Columbia known for classic Southern country cooking and meat-and-three comfort food at budget-friendly prices.

Zesto

Zesto is a long-running, retro spot landmarked by its giant soft-serve cone sign on 12th Street. Operating since 1949, it is famous for crispy, pressure-fried chicken, classic "Zestoburgers", chili slaw dogs, and chocolate-dipped soft-serve cones.

Italian

Emphasizes high-quality, simple ingredients allowed to shine through classic preparation. Built around olive oil, fresh garlic, tomatoes, pasta, cheese, and fresh herbs like basil and oregano.

Villa Tronco

Villa Tronco serves traditional, Southern Italian comfort food made from original family recipes—most notably their house-made square thin-crust pizza, baked pasta, and signature chicken and veal entrees, followed by their legendary homemade cheesecake.

Travinia

Travinia is a polished, Italian restaurant known for scratch-made Tuscan specialties, pasta, and seafood. The warm, upscale-casual setting features a curated wine list and signature dishes like Sinatra Chicken and Lasagna Bolognese. It is a popular spot for date nights

Budget

Focuses on quick, convenient, and wallet-friendly dining options that are easy to grab on the go. Highlights local fast-casual chains, street food vendors, 24/7 diners, drive-thrus, and affordable neighborhood joints offering generous portions at low prices.

FuruSato Bento

FuruSato Bento is a casual, Japanese konbini-style (convenience store) eatery located in the Five Points neighborhood of Columbia, South Carolina. Inspired by Japanese convenience food, it specializes in quick, authentic, and affordable meals.

Groucho's Deli

Groucho's Deli is a legendary Columbia sandwich spot famous for warm "Dipper" sandwiches like the STP Dipper (turkey, roast beef, bacon, melted Swiss). It's best known for its proprietary, sweet-and-tangy Formula "45" Sauce served on the side for dunking.

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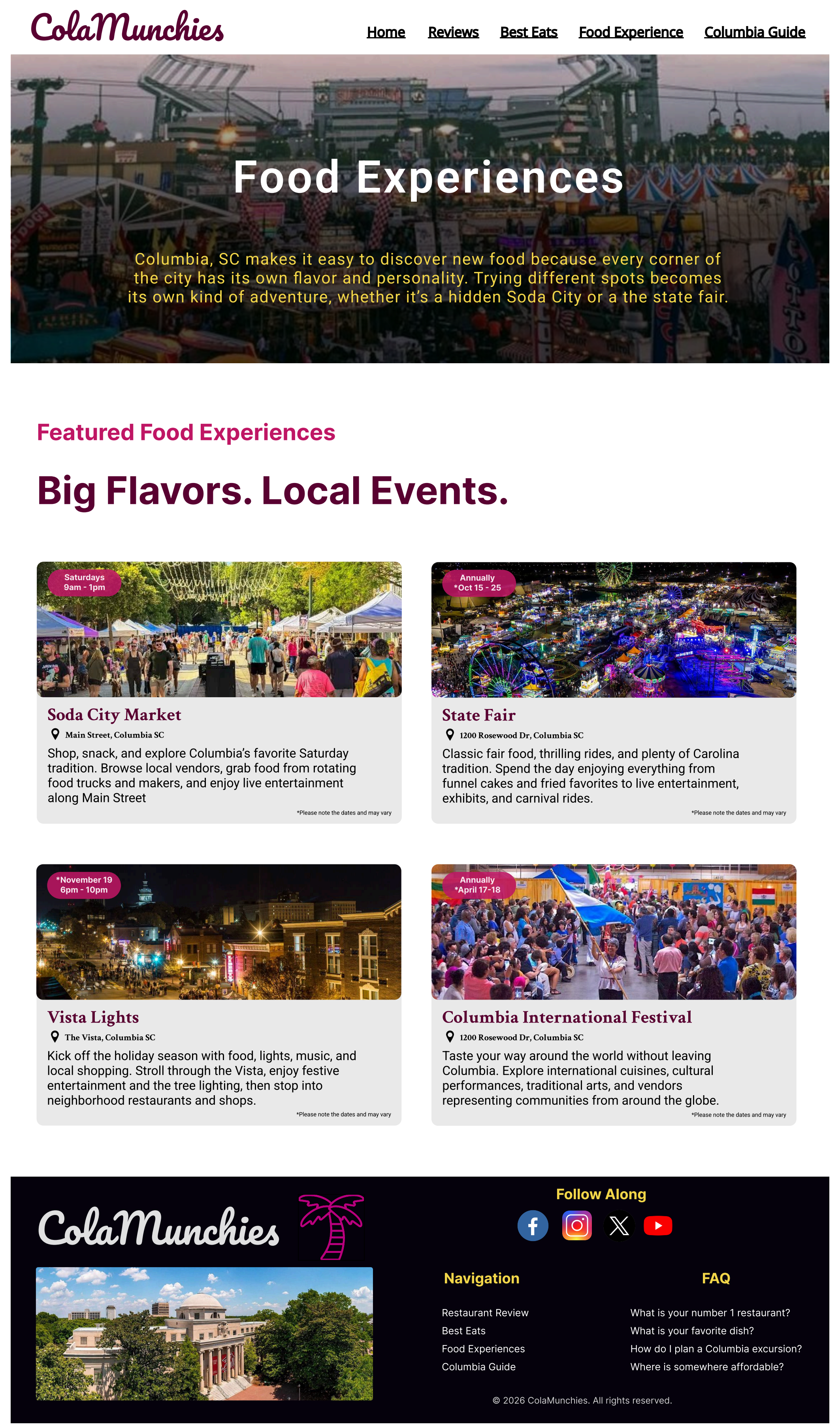

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Food Experiences

Columbia, SC makes it easy to discover new food because every corner of the city has its own flavor and personality. Trying different spots becomes its own kind of adventure, whether it's a hidden Soda City or a the state fair.

Featured Food Experiences

Big Flavors. Local Events.

Saturdays 9am - 1pm

Soda City Market

Main Street, Columbia SC

Shop, snack, and explore Columbia's favorite Saturday tradition. Browse local vendors, grab food from rotating food trucks and makers, and enjoy live entertainment along Main Street

*Please note the dates and may vary

Annually *Oct 15 - 25

State Fair

1200 Rosewood Dr, Columbia SC

Classic fair food, thrilling rides, and plenty of Carolina tradition. Spend the day enjoying everything from funnel cakes and fried favorites to live entertainment, exhibits, and carnival rides.

*Please note the dates and may vary

*November 19 6pm - 10pm

Vista Lights

The Vista, Columbia SC

Kick off the holiday season with food, lights, music, and local shopping. Stroll through the Vista, enjoy festive entertainment and the tree lighting, then stop into neighborhood restaurants and shops.

*Please note the dates and may vary

Annually *April 17-18

Columbia International Festival

1200 Rosewood Dr, Columbia SC

Taste your way around the world without leaving Columbia. Explore international cuisines, cultural performances, traditional arts, and vendors representing communities from around the globe.

*Please note the dates and may vary

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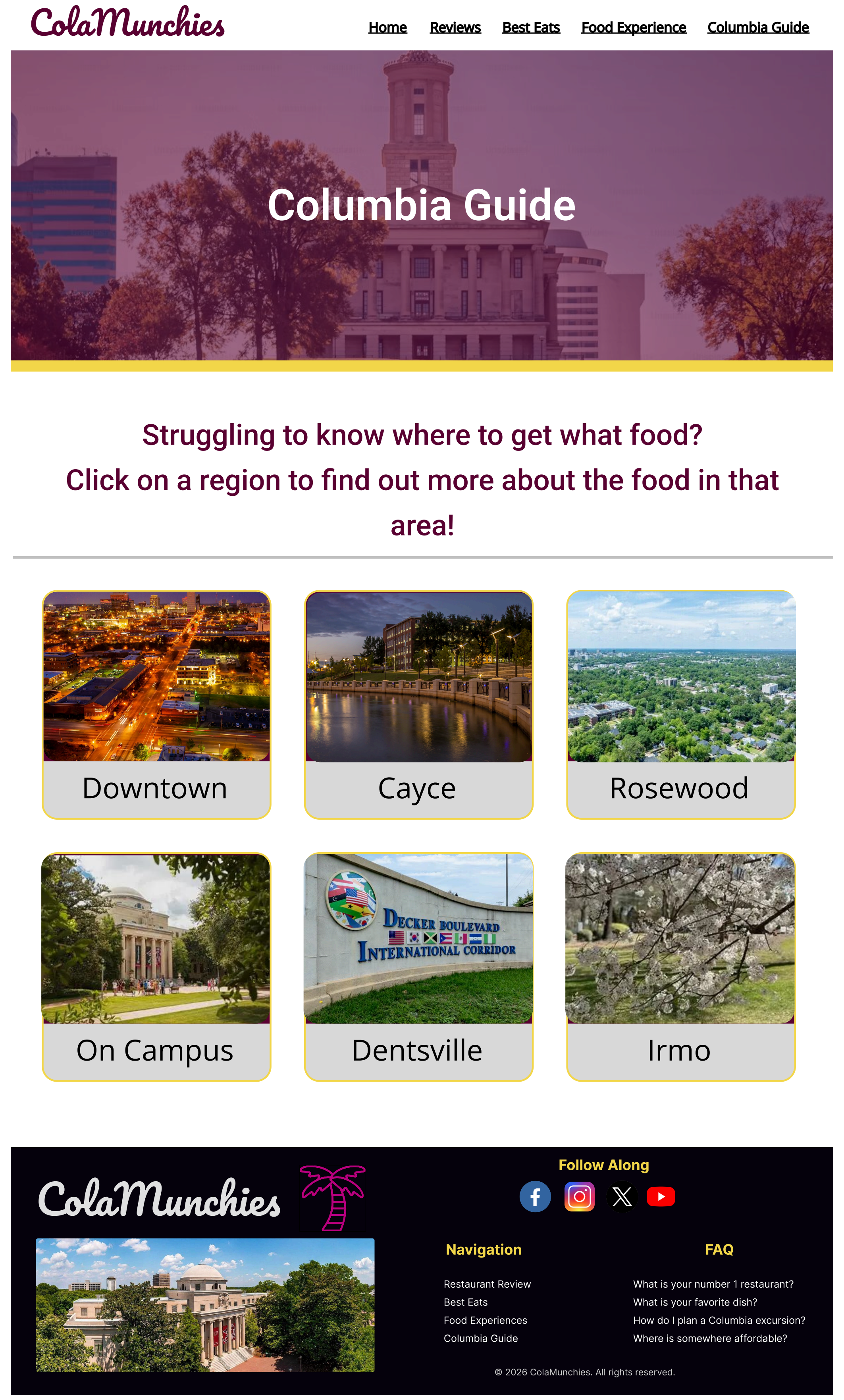

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Columbia Guide

Struggling to know where to get what food?
Click on a region to find out more about the food in that area!

Downtown | Cayce | Rosewood

On Campus | Dentsville | Irmo

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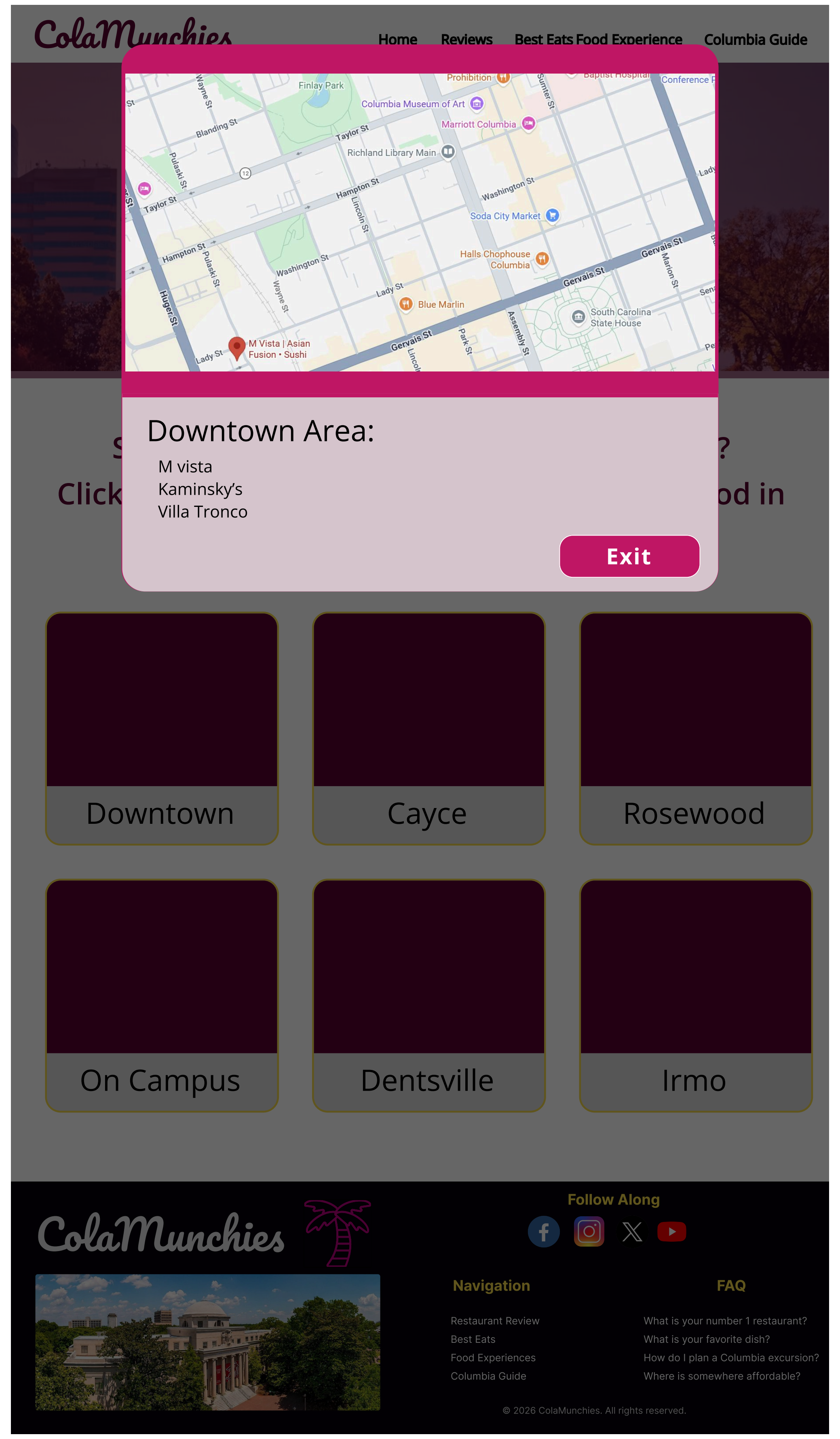

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Downtown Area:

M vista
Kaminsky's
Villa Tronco

Exit

S ?
Click od in

Downtown | Cayce | Rosewood

On Campus | Dentsville | Irmo

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